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June 18, 2026

Dr. Tara La Rose
MREB Chair
Associate Professor
School of Social Work
Faculty of Social Sciences

Re: Response to ethics review comments from the MREB Chair, MREB#8215

Dear Dr. La Rose:

Thank you and the reviewers for the feedback on our MREB re-submission. I apologize that some of the changes from the previous resubmission were not incorporated into the form. Partway through the previous revisions, I noticed that the form was not remembering some of my changes. (Maybe the session had expired?) I thought I found all the changes that it missed, but obviously my search was not complete. I will double verify the changes this time.

In response to your e-mail, dated June 18, 2026, we have revised the submission again to incorporate the new feedback. We provide a summary below.

- 1.4 Please select the status of your application. “When re-submitting your protocol, be sure to select the first item: ‘My revised application in response to ethics review comments from the MREB Chair’. You will then be prompted to upload your Summary of Revisions document in 1.5 - the subsequent section.”

This has been done. This document provides a summary of the revisions made in response to the ethics review comments.

- 8.2 Study Purpose/Research Question Description. (I’m repeating the feedback on the previous review because the change didn’t come through last time) “Minor comment, this may be a typo, or an incomplete response; ie. is the question mark intentional?”

The question mark was not intentional; it has been removed. This change should now be reflected in the revised form.

- 10.6.7 Upload your email script(s) sent directly to participants. “Thank you for clarifying that consent will occur via email. While we understand this approach, we advise that you modify the consent language to strengthen the notion of active consent. So, in paragraph 6, sentence 5, please revise by adding the bracketed text ‘If you choose to participate in the study, please let me know by [responding to this email and stating that you want to participate in the study. Also, if you have any questions you wanted answered before deciding to participate, please let us know.]’ ”

This change has been made in both email consent scripts.

- 10.6.7 Upload your email script(s) sent directly to participants. “Please be sure to delete the old versions of the documents uploaded (also commented in section 16)”

I apologize for the oversight. The old versions of the documents have been deleted and the new versions have been uploaded.

- 10.6.12 Upload your appreciation letter/certificate thank you card for participants. “Please include a date regarding withdrawing from the project.”

The date of July 31, 2026 has been added. The new document has been uploaded (and the old ones deleted)

- 15.2.2 Describe the administrative purpose(s) for which this information is required. “Don’t leave this in your email account.”

The response to 15.2.2 has been revised to indicate that the email messages will be deleted after by July 31, 2026.

- 15.2.2 Describe the administrative purpose(s) for which this information is required. “We don’t see any changes here but the response to chair document notes that 15.2.2. has been modified. Please make those changes in the entry here.”

The text of 15.2.2 has now been revised as instructed in the previous review.

- 15.11.1 Describe how research data will be collected securely. “We don’t see any changes here but the response to chair document notes that 15.11.1 has been modified.”

The text of 15.11.1 has now been revised as instructed in the previous review.

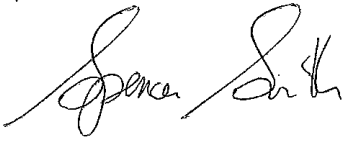
- 16.6.2 Upload your oral / telephone consent script. “Please be sure to delete the old versions of the documents uploaded (here and in 16.6.3)”

Response

In the cases where there was a Version 1 and Version 2 of a document, both versions have been deleted and a third version has been uploaded. The third version accepts changes from the previous

version's track changes. The third version will only show changes that have been made since version 2.

Best regards,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Spencer Smith". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Spencer" and last name "Smith" clearly distinguishable.

Spencer Smith